This week’s lesson showed me that a prototype is meant to be simple. It should be about what the product does and not what it looks like. The goal is to test an idea I have easily. I also learned about journey boards. A storyboard shows each step a user takes, from the problem to the goal. It also shows how they feel at each step. I had never thought about emotions as part of design before.

This helped change my approach to my investing web app. I wanted to immediately start producing final products after interviews. Instead, I mapped out the journey of a beginner investor. This helped me see where they might get caught up. Because of this I added plain language summaries and explanations over key terms a user will need to know. If they just bought their first stock and want to know how it is doing, they will have the summary to easily check what the company has been up to. Going step by step showed me two places where they might get stuck. The first was set up. If it takes too many steps, they will quit before they see any value. The second was finance terms like "P/E ratio" or "dividend yield." A beginner sees those and might feel overwhelmed. This showed me how important plain language will be throughout development.

I used Claude to help me with my storyboard and implementing features. AI made the first version fast, but it did not know my users. I personally changed how the summary described the company and the wording for each explanation.